

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

Head of Cloud Operations | Cloud Operating Model | SLO/SLA Frameworks | Observability | AIOps | Multi-Cloud | Kubernetes

+91-9440493097

pavan.nayakanti@hotmail.com

linkedin.com/in/pavan-nayakanti

Pune, India

EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

IRIS Software - India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

Sep 2020 - Present Hyderabad, India

- Defined and owned the cloud operating model for ADP's SRE organisation - establishing reliability standards, observability frameworks, incident/problem management, change control, and release readiness across mission-critical cloud platforms.
- Designed SLO/SLA frameworks, runbooks, escalation models, and on-call structures across multi-client cloud platforms (BMO, ADP, Charles Schwab); governed error budgets tied to business commitments.
- Moved ADP operations from reactive firefighting to proactive reliability - deployed Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, and AppDynamics for full-stack observability; established chaos engineering (Keptn) to surface failure modes before incidents; reduced MTTR by 40%+ via Ansible automated remediation.
- Built SRE/CloudOps organisation from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US; built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from ground zero - greenfield operating model, incident governance, on-call frameworks, and RCA discipline established from scratch.
- Led RCA discipline and recurring failure reduction - instituted blameless postmortem culture, automated remediation workflows, and measurable improvement in change success rate and incident recurrence.
- Standardised monitoring, logging, alerting, and operational dashboards across distributed cloud platforms; integrated Splunk log aggregation with CI/CD workflows for proactive incident detection.
- Drove capacity planning, cost optimisation (FinOps), and disaster recovery for BMO's AWS estate - rightsized workloads, eliminated waste, and designed HA/DR architecture from day one of the cloud migration.
- Delivered modeas high-throughput deployment platform (200+ builds/hour); eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually - improving day-two operations maturity from manual to fully automated release cadence.
- Deployed GenAI/AIOps assistants on Azure and AWS for BMO - AI-powered risk summarisation and automated Q&A reducing manual operations effort; led AIOps adoption across engineering teams.
- Presented reliability strategies, SRE KPIs, and operational outcomes to VP and C-suite stakeholders at ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO.

SUMMARY

20+ year Cloud Operations and SRE leader who defines and owns cloud operating models at enterprise scale. Built SRE organisations from zero - growing teams from 4 to 40 engineers across ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC - while cutting MTTR by 40%+ through AIOps-driven automated remediation, chaos engineering, and blameless postmortem culture. Expert in SLO/SLA framework design, full-stack observability (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, AppDynamics), Kubernetes, multi-cloud (AWS/Azure/GCP), and moving organisations from reactive firefighting to proactive reliability engineering.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- MTTR -40% - ADP CloudOps**
Transformed ADP SRE from reactive firefighting to proactive operations -- chaos engineering (Keptn) + Ansible automated remediation + blameless postmortem culture reduced MTTR by 40%+ across mission-critical platforms.
- Greenfield SRE Org: 4 → 40**
Defined and built ADP's cloud operating model from scratch -- scaled SRE org from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US. Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero in a single quarter.
- 200+ Deployments/hr - Day-Two Ops**
Designed modeas platform handling 200+ builds/hour; eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and improved deployment cadence by 600% -- raising day-two operations maturity from manual to fully automated.
- 5 Weeks → 5 Hours - Toil Elimination**
Robo Deployment Framework cut application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 250+ apps at RBC -- standardising operational runbooks and eliminating manual release toil at scale.

Automation Technology Specialist

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

 Jun 2018 - Sep 2020  Toronto, Canada

- Established **SRE principles and operational governance frameworks** within RBC Insurance's DevSecOps programme - observability standards, incident classification, and reliability-focused deployment gates across 250+ applications in a **regulated enterprise environment** (SOX/GDPR).
- Operationalised the **DORA framework** - tracking Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary operational health metrics across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance.
- Implemented **Splunk log aggregation and alerting** pipelines; designed the Robo Deployment Framework enabling self-service CI/CD - reduced application onboarding from **5 weeks to 5 hours** (98% reduction).
- Governed change management and **ITSM transformation** across 250+ applications and 60+ teams - enforcing compliance, audit-ready delivery, and structured regulatory reporting.

Automation Architect

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

 Feb 2017 - Jun 2018  Toronto, Canada

- Designed **fault-tolerant Kubernetes and Helm-orchestrated deployment pipelines** for zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms; standardised container orchestration and operational runbooks.
- Led enterprise automation delivery - **80+ applications and 250+ components** automated across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks; established Python automation frameworks at scale.

Technology Manager

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. - Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

 Jul 2015 - Feb 2017  Noida, India

- Architected and delivered **zero-downtime data centre migration** for Adobe - owned full plan, execution, and production cutover with no business disruption across all workloads.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and enterprise data migration at scale; drove schema redesign and ETL re-engineering with minimal service disruption.

Sr. SDET - QA, Automation & Production Engineering

Microsoft Corporation - India

 Jul 2007 - Dec 2014  Hyderabad, India

- Dual mandate as Production Engineering owner - **full cloud operations lifecycle** for Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC; sustained **99.99% uptime over 7 years** with zero customer-impacting incidents.
- Defined and enforced all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security); managed end-to-end incident response, RCA, and capacity planning across Windows and Linux infrastructure.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified SRE (iSRE)

iSRE Institute

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer

CNCF - 2025

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services - 2026

GCP Professional Cloud Architect

Google Cloud - 2026

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

Project Management Institute

Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)

Microsoft

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024

Woolf University

General Management Program (GMP)

2022

ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science

2002

Osmania University